Cognitive Behavioral Therapy: Clinical Protocols & Behavioral Interventions
Practitioner Reference Handbook

1. Core Principles of CBT
Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT) operates on the empirically verified premise that cognitive appraisals directly influence emotional and behavioral responses. Dysfunctional thinking is common to all psychological disturbances.

1.1 The Cognitive Triad
Aaron Beck formulated the cognitive triad: negative views about the self, the world/environment, and the future. Systematic cognitive restructuring trains individuals to identify automatic thoughts and subject them to evidence-based evaluation.

2. Structured Interventions

2.1 Thought Records (Dysfunctional Thought Record - DTR)

Clients track triggering situations, automatic thoughts, underlying emotions (rated 0-100), evidence supporting the thought, evidence contradicting the thought, alternative balanced thoughts, and post-intervention emotion ratings.

2.2 Behavioral Experiments

Unlike purely reflective discussion, behavioral experiments provide real-world testing grounds to challenge catastrophic predictions. Hypotheses are explicitly written prior to the task.